WRITING CENTER
EVERY ASSIGNMENT. EVERY STAGE. EVERY STUDENT.

Avoiding "AI-Like" Writing: A Quick Guide

Turnitin and other AI detectors sometimes flag human writing as "AI-generated" when it contains patterns common in machine-produced text. Recognizing and revising these features helps your writing sound more natural, analytical, and authentically *yours*.

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1 Repetition and Predictable Rhythm

AI-like pattern: Sentences with identical structure or pacing.

> *"It presents their features, emphasizes their strengths, and explains their benefits."*

Revise for variety:

> *"This comparison highlights key features of each method and explains how their strengths complement one another."*

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2 Generic or Overly Polished Language

AI-like pattern: Perfect grammar but vague, interchangeable vocabulary (*significant, important, effective, essential*).

Revise for specificity: Replace broad adjectives with precise terms from your field.

> *"Effective tools for analysis"* → *"Scalable tools for database performance analysis."*

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3 Lack of Depth or Synthesis

AI-like pattern: Paragraphs summarize rather than connect ideas.

Revise for synthesis: Explain *how* or *why* ideas relate.

> *"Use Case Diagrams and DFDs show different perspectives"* → *"While Use Case Diagrams map user interactions, DFDs trace data flow—together offering a holistic model of system behavior."*

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4 Impersonal, Template-Based Openings

AI-like pattern: "This paper will discuss…" / "In conclusion, this paper explains…"

Revise for authenticity:

> *"This analysis compares…"* → *"By contrasting these models, the study clarifies how each supports system design."*

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5 Overuse of Transitions and Stock Phrases

AI-like pattern: Frequent use of connectors like *Moreover, Furthermore, Additionally,* or *In conclusion.*

Revise for natural flow:

> Combine sentences or vary transitions (*"Another key factor is…"* or *"A related challenge involves…"*).

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6️⃣ Perfect Uniformity with No Voice

AI-like pattern: Grammatically flawless but flat, detached tone.

Revise for human voice:

- Use first person when allowed (*"In this project, I analyzed…"*).
- Show reasoning or reflection (*"This suggests that…"* or *"A likely explanation is…"*).

7️⃣ Dropped Citations or No Signal Phrases

AI-like pattern: Parenthetical citations appear suddenly with no context.

Revise for integration:

"According to Smith (2023),…" or *"Recent studies confirm…"*

8️⃣ Short, Isolated Paragraphs

AI-like pattern: Each paragraph summarizes one concept with no transitions.

Revise for cohesion: Use linking sentences and connect ideas across paragraphs.

9️⃣ Mechanical Introductions and Conclusions

AI-like pattern: Predictable, formulaic restatements.

Revise for reflection: End with insight or implication—what the findings *mean* or *why they matter.*

🔟 No Minor Errors or Stylistic Shifts

AI-like pattern: Text appears unnaturally perfect, with zero sentence-level variation.

Revise: Read aloud and revise for rhythm; natural writing includes small stylistic fluctuations.

📘 Writing Center Tip

AI detectors look for *patterns*, not proof.

If your writing is flagged, it doesn't mean it's AI-generated—it may simply read as too mechanical.

Focus on **specificity, variety, and synthesis**, and your natural human voice will shine through.